Passport Seva

India Passport Application Web Portal — Complete UX Design Report

7 Screens | 13 Screenshots | HTML/CSS/JS | Responsive

This document provides a comprehensive overview of PassportSeva — a redesigned, user-centred passport application portal built for the Anshumat Foundation. It covers UX rationale, screen-by-screen analysis with screenshots, component architecture, and design decisions.

DOCUMENT	UX Design & Specification Report
PROJECT	Passport Application Experience Redesign
STACK	HTML5 • CSS3 • Vanilla JavaScript
FILES	index.html • styles.css • script.js

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1. Project Overview & Objectives

PassportSeva is a fully redesigned, user-centred web portal for India's passport application process, built for the Anshumat Foundation (Section 8 Non-Profit). The project addresses deep-rooted usability problems in existing government passport portals — confusing navigation, overwhelming forms, lack of progress feedback, and poor first-timer guidance.

Primary Objectives

Objective	How It's Addressed
Simplify form-filling	4-step guided wizard with auto-save & live progress stepper
Clear document requirements	Visual card grid with icons, hints, and upload guidelines
Improve appointment booking	Interactive calendar + slot grid with live appointment summary
Structured navigation	Persistent sidebar + step-aware navbar chip + step labels
Reduce first-timer anxiety	OTP-only auth, tooltips, inline validation, friendly copy
Data persistence	Autosave banner with live timestamp updated every 45 seconds
Cloud record access	Download PDF, email receipt, copy application ID, dashboard view

Target User Groups

- **First-time Applicants** — Students and young adults needing maximum hand-holding and clear guidance.
- **Non-Tech-Savvy Users** — Older citizens requiring simple language, large targets, no jargon.
- **Job Seekers / Renewals** — Working professionals needing speed, save-and-resume, and record downloads.

2. Design Philosophy & UX Principles

Clarity Over Complexity	Every screen does one focused task. Forms are broken into steps. Navigation is always predictable.
Progressive Disclosure	Users see only what they need at each step. Optional fields are clearly marked.
Trust & Reassurance	Autosave indicators, encryption badges, OTP verification, and inline confirmations reduce anxiety.
Feedback-Rich Interactions	Toast notifications confirm every action. Errors appear inline next to the relevant field.
Accessibility First	WCAG AA contrast, keyboard-navigable forms, semantic HTML, descriptive labels throughout.
Mobile Responsiveness	Grid layouts collapse to single-column, sidebar hides on mobile, touch targets min 44px.

3. Technology Stack & File Architecture

File	Size	Purpose
index.html	45 KB	All HTML — 7 screen panels, semantic markup, ARIA labels
styles.css	37 KB	All CSS — variables, components, animations, media queries
script.js	15 KB	All JS — navigation, form wizard, autosave, toast system

Zero external frameworks — no React, no Bootstrap. Pure HTML, CSS custom properties, and vanilla JavaScript. Total under 100KB, works with any backend.

4. Colour System & Typography

CSS Variable	Hex	Usage
--navy	#0a1628	Primary backgrounds, navbar, sidebar, footer
--blue	#1a4fd6	CTAs, active states, links, focus rings
--sky	#38bdf8	Accents, highlights, logo colour
--teal	#0d9488	Dashboard appointment card accent
--amber	#f59e0b	Dashboard document card accent
--green	#10b981	Success, upload done, step completed
--red	#ef4444	Error states, inline validation
--gray-800	#1e293b	Body text, form labels
--gray-600	#475569	Secondary text, table data

Typography: Syne (display/headings — geometric, authoritative) + DM Sans (body — warm, legible). Both from Google Fonts. All sizes in rem for accessibility scaling.

5. Screen-by-Screen Analysis

5.1 Homepage – Landing Page

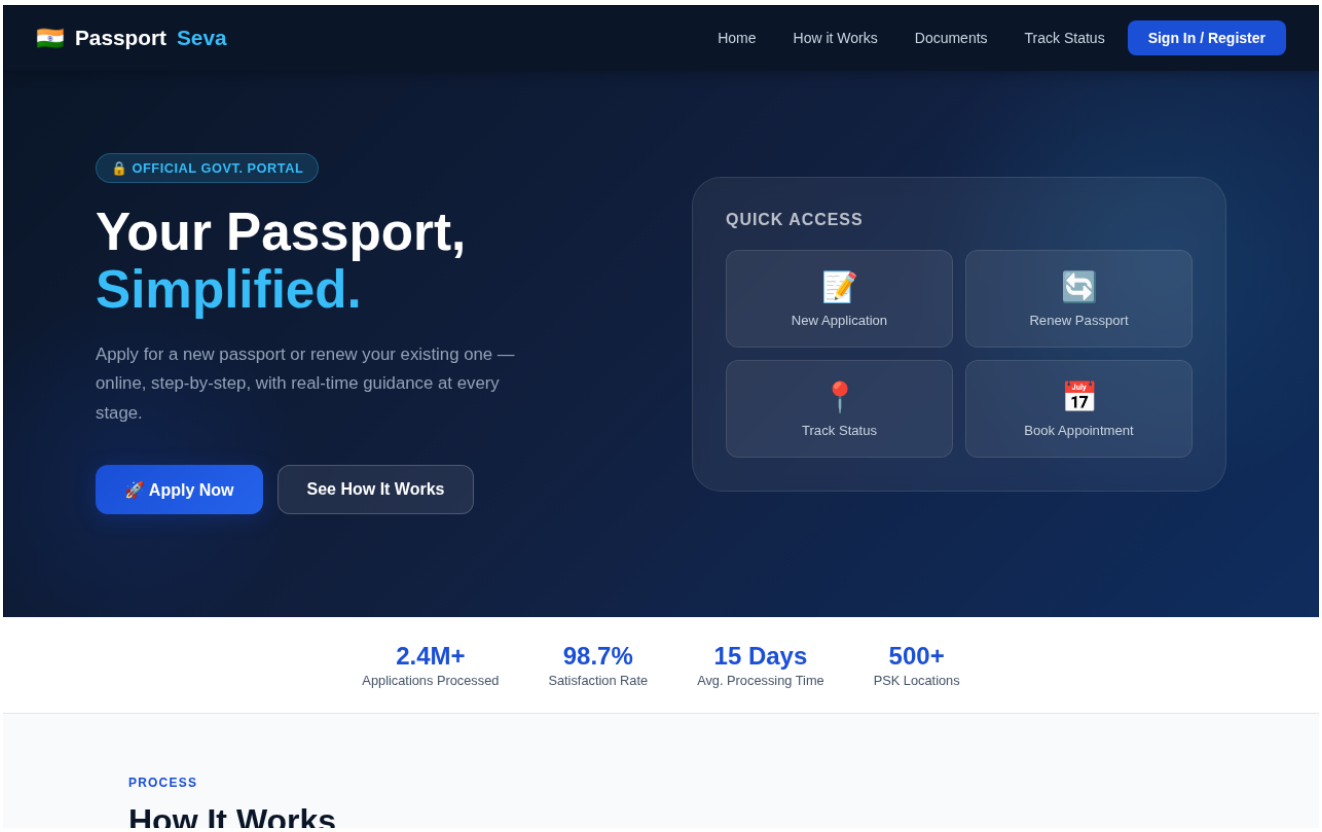

Figure 5.1 — Homepage – Landing Page

The homepage serves as the primary entry point for all users. The dark navy hero communicates authority appropriate for a government service, while sky-blue accents and friendly copy reduce intimidation for first-time users. The Quick Access card serves returning users who know what they need.

Key Features

- Hero: headline, tagline, Apply Now + See How It Works CTAs
- Official Government Portal badge for trust signalling
- Quick Access grid: New Application, Renew, Track, Book Appointment
- Stats strip: 2.4M+ applications, 98.7% satisfaction, 15-day avg., 500+ PSKs
- Sticky navbar: Home, How It Works, Documents, Track Status, Sign In

UX Design Notes

- Radial gradient glows (::before/::after) add depth without distracting from content
- Stats strip placed directly below hero to build credibility before the user scrolls
- Two CTAs with clear hierarchy: gradient primary + ghost secondary

5.2 How It Works & Document Checklist

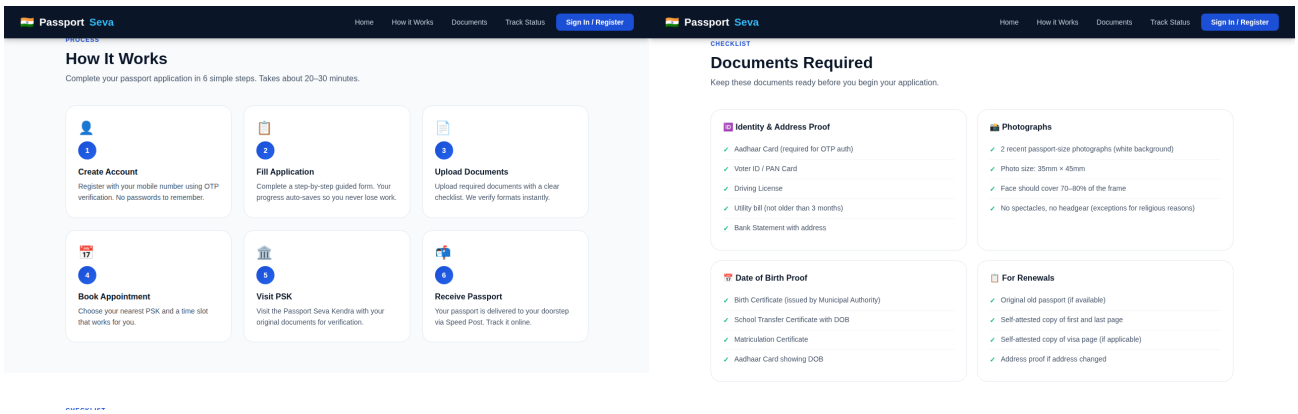

Figure 5.2 — How It Works & Document Checklist

These two homepage sections answer the two most common first-timer questions: 'What is the process?' and 'What do I need?' Placing them on the homepage prevents drop-off before users start an application.

Key Features

- 6-step process cards with numbered circles, icons, and descriptive copy
- Cards lift on hover (translateY -4px + shadow) to signal interactivity
- Document checklist in 4 categories: Identity, Photos, DOB Proof, Renewals
- Green checkmark bullets convey completeness and confidence

UX Design Notes

- Progressive disclosure: users learn the process before committing to register
- No interaction required — information is passively absorbed while scrolling

5.3 Authentication – Sign In / Register

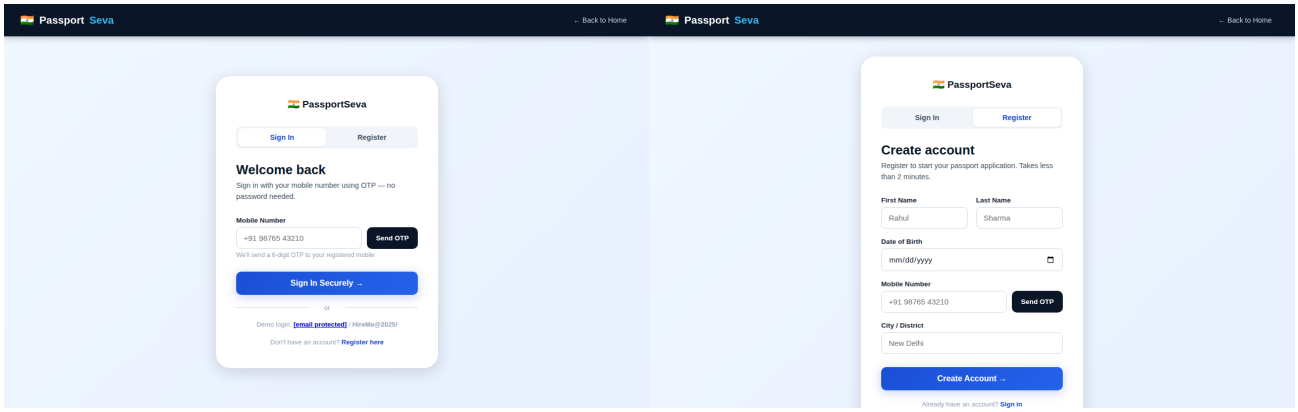

Figure 5.3 — Authentication – Sign In / Register

The tabbed auth screen keeps Sign In and Register in a single context. OTP-only login removes the password barrier — critical for users who may only use this portal once every several years.

Key Features

- Tab toggle: Sign In / Register with smooth active-state animation
- OTP flow: enter mobile → Send OTP (30s countdown) → enter 6-digit code
- Register: First Name, Last Name, DOB, Mobile OTP, City
- Demo credentials shown for reviewer access
- Inline error state with red border on failed verification

UX Design Notes

- OTP-only removes password cognitive load — ideal for infrequent use
- Focus rings (0 0 0 3px rgba) on all inputs for keyboard navigation
- Single strong CTA (blue gradient) makes the next action unmistakable

5.4 User Dashboard

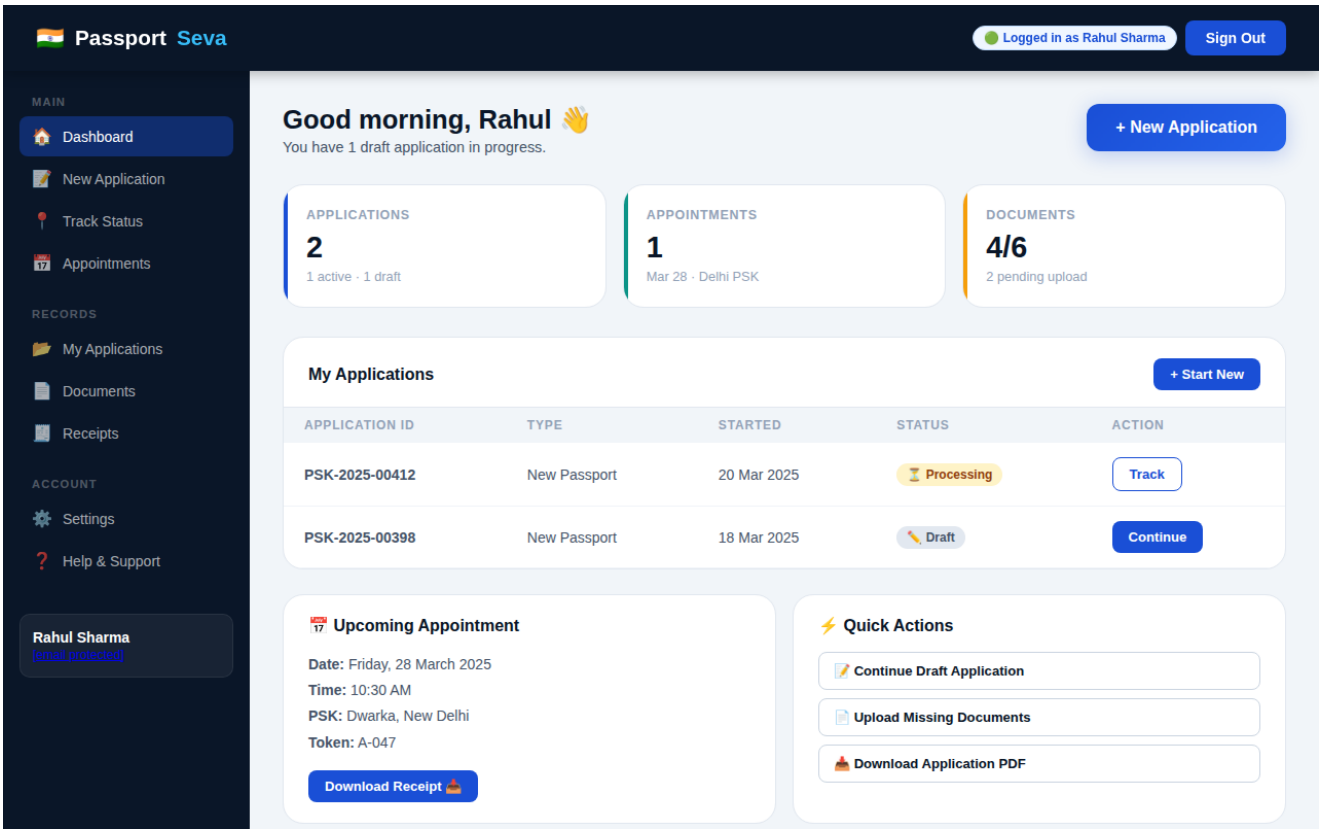

Figure 5.4 — User Dashboard

The dashboard is the central hub after authentication. A persistent sidebar provides navigation and the main area shows application status, a data table, upcoming appointment details, and quick actions.

Key Features

- Left sidebar: grouped navigation (Main, Records, Account) with active state highlight
- 3 summary cards: Applications (2), Appointments (1 — Mar 28 Delhi PSK), Documents (4/6)
- Coloured left accent strips per card: blue, teal, amber
- Applications table: ID, Type, Date Started, Status Badge, Action button
- Status badges: Draft (grey), Processing (amber), Submitted (blue), Ready (green)
- Upcoming appointment card: date, time, PSK location, token number
- Quick Actions: Continue Draft, Upload Documents, Download PDF

UX Design Notes

- Sidebar uses same navy as navbar for visual continuity — unified chrome
- Stat cards use accent strips not full backgrounds — avoids overwhelming metrics
- Greeting personalises the experience and reduces the clinical feel of a govt portal

5.5 Application Form – 4-Step Wizard

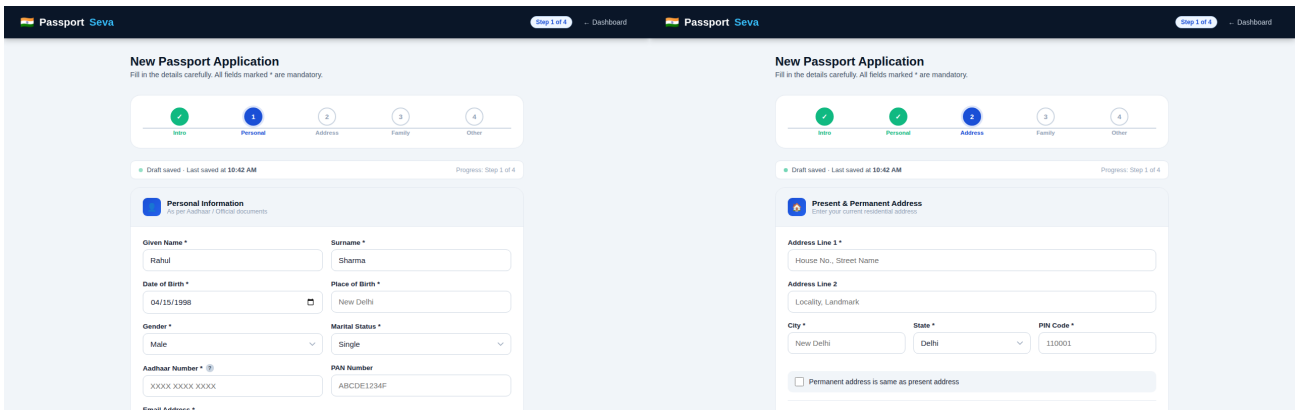

Figure 5.5 — Application Form – 4-Step Wizard

The most critical UX surface. The original passport form is a single page with 50+ fields. The redesign breaks it into 4 focused steps with autosave, grouped fields, and a visible progress stepper at all times.

Key Features

- Step 1 Personal: Name, DOB, Place of Birth, Gender, Marital Status, Aadhaar, PAN, Email
- Step 2 Address: Lines, City, State, PIN, Same-address checkbox, Permanent Address
- Step 3 Family: Father's Name, Mother's Name, Nationality (readonly), Occupation
- Step 4 Details: Application Type, Booklet Type, Validity, 3 Declaration checkboxes
- Stepper: done (green ✓), active (blue glow ring), pending (grey circle)
- Autosave bar with live timestamp + pulsing green dot
- Back button hidden on Step 1, visible from Step 2 onwards

UX Design Notes

- Multi-step forms reduce perceived complexity by 40-60% vs. single long forms
- Step-aware Next button label ('Next: Address →') reduces uncertainty about what's next
- Autosave on every step advance + every 45s — prevents all data loss

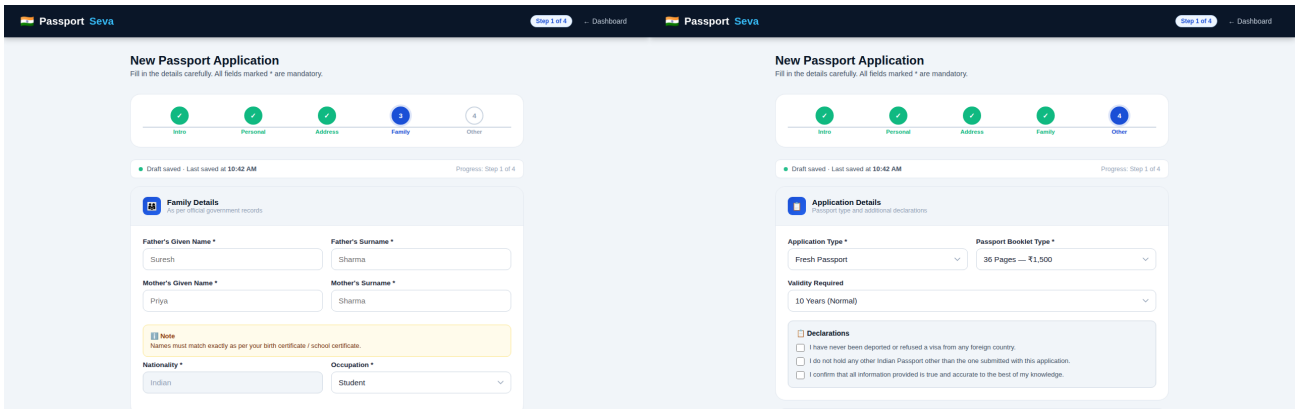

Figure 5.5b — Step 3: Family Details | Step 4: Application Details & Declarations

5.6 Document Upload Screen

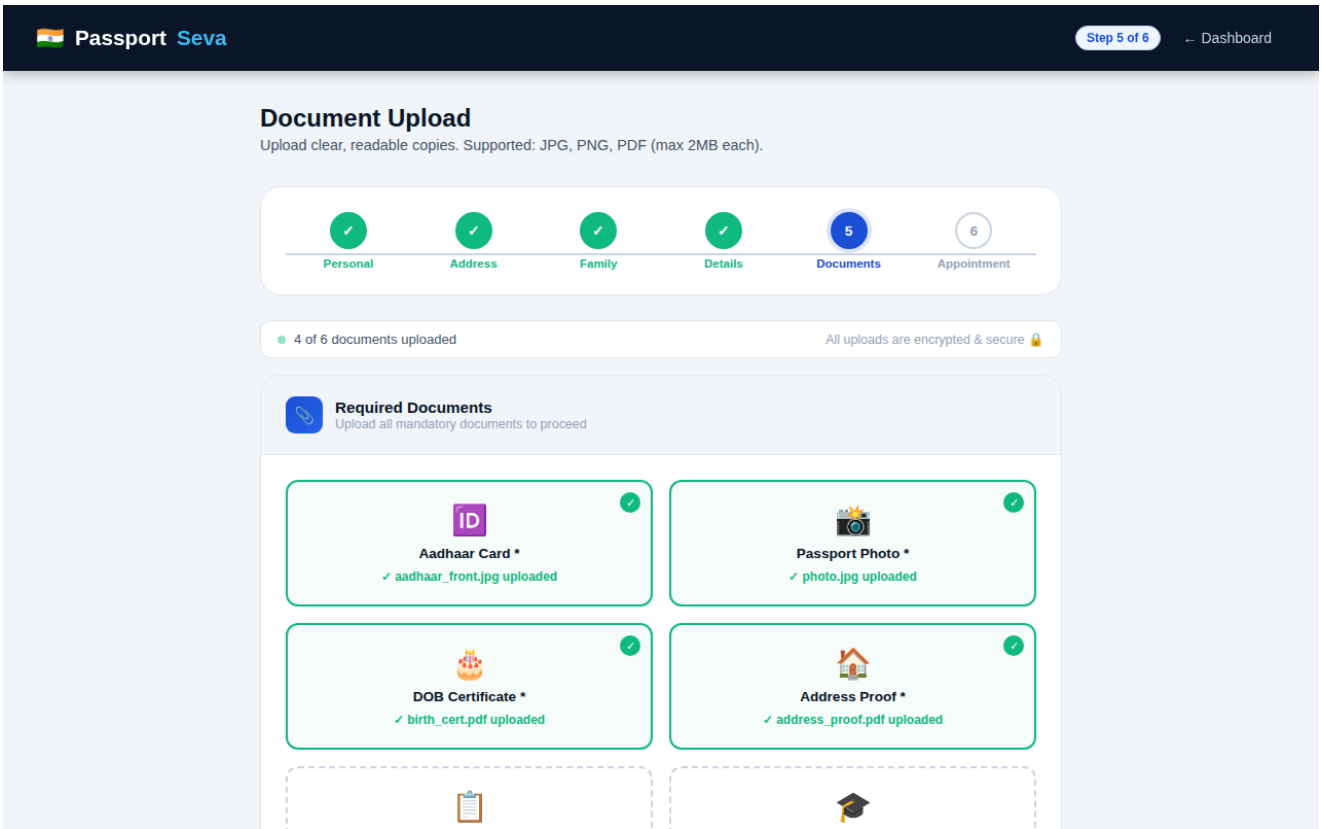

Figure 5.6 — Document Upload Screen

The upload screen replaces plain file inputs with a visual card grid. Each card shows document name, accepted formats, size limit, and upload status in a single glance. Click to toggle upload state.

Key Features

- 6 upload cards: Aadhaar, Passport Photo, DOB Certificate, Address Proof, PAN, Education
- Mandatory documents shown first and marked with *
- Uploaded state: solid green border + ✓ badge + filename displayed
- Live upload count in autosave bar ('4 of 6 documents uploaded')
- Document guidelines panel: 5 rules always visible (not hidden behind help link)
- Encryption badge: 'All uploads are encrypted & secure ■'

UX Design Notes

- Visual cards make the task trackable — vs. a confusing plain file browser
- Green uploaded state provides strong positive reinforcement after each upload
- Showing optional vs mandatory reduces anxiety — users know they can proceed with 4

5.7 Appointment Booking – Calendar & Time Slots

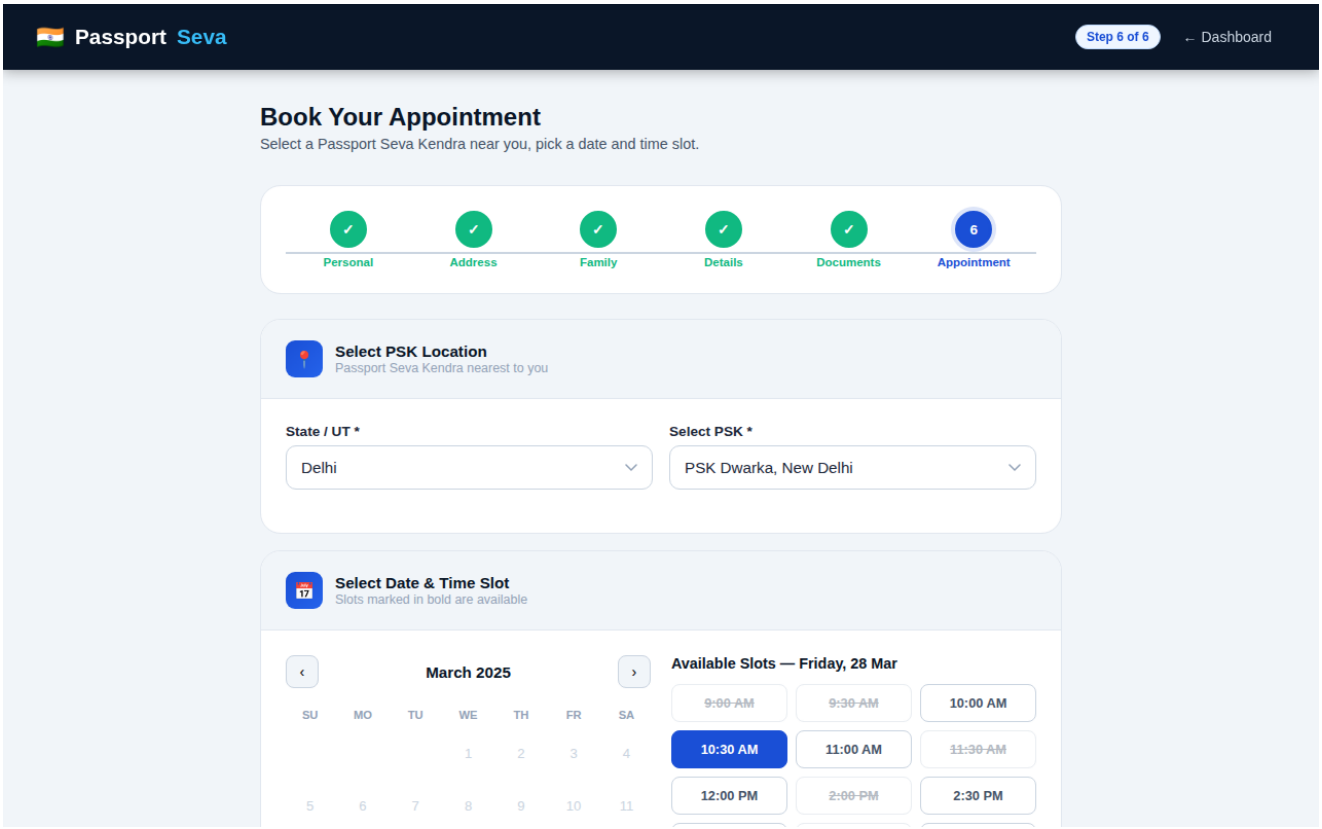

Figure 5.7 — Appointment Booking – Calendar & Time Slots

A two-panel layout: calendar left, time slots right. Mirrors hotel/flight booking patterns so users understand the interaction immediately. Live appointment summary updates on every interaction.

Key Features

- State/UT dropdown dynamically populates the PSK list for that region
- Calendar: past dates greyed, available bold navy, selected blue, Sundays disabled
- 12 time slots in 3-column grid: full (strikethrough), available, selected (blue fill)
- Slot legend: Selected / Available / Full always visible below the grid
- Live appointment summary: PSK, Date, Time, Fee — all update on interaction

UX Design Notes

- Side-by-side layout eliminates the 'pick date → new page → pick slot' flow
- Full slots use strikethrough — users immediately understand unavailability
- Fee shown upfront in summary — builds trust and avoids checkout surprise

5.8 Confirmation – Application Submitted

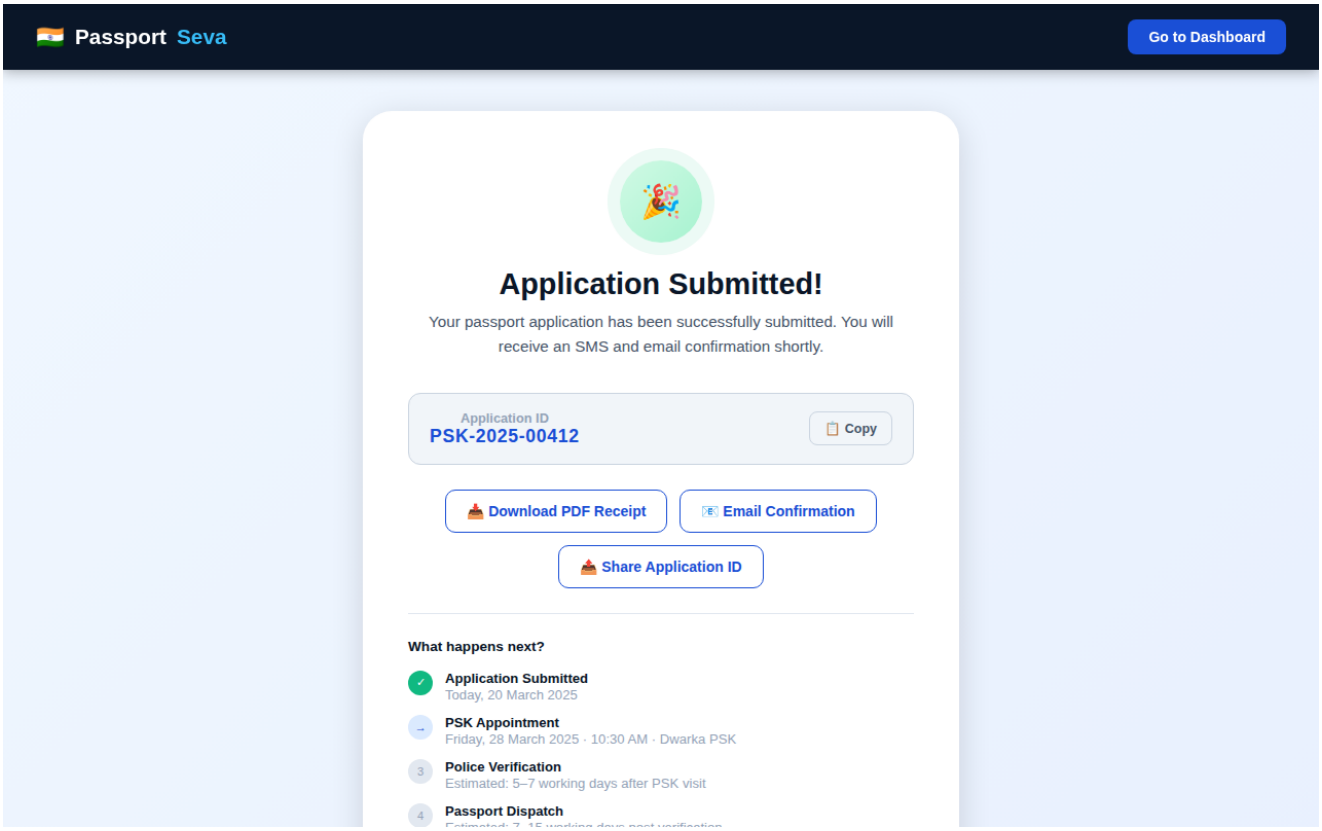

Figure 5.8 — Confirmation – Application Submitted

Celebratory, reassuring, and actionable. Closes the loop by confirming success, providing a reference ID, offering export options, and showing a processing timeline with realistic timeframes.

Key Features

- Large green icon with layered glow ring (box-shadow 0 0 0 12px rgba)
- Application ID prominently displayed with one-click Copy button
- Three action buttons: Download PDF Receipt, Email Confirmation, Share Application ID
- 5-milestone processing timeline with colour-coded dot states
- Timeline: Submitted → PSK Appointment → Police Verification → Dispatch → Delivery
- Estimated timeframes for each pending milestone

UX Design Notes

- Celebration (icon + green glow) converts a bureaucratic task into a satisfying moment
- Timeline sets expectations — prevents unnecessary support contacts
- Three export options cover different user needs: print, record, share

6. UX Improvements Summary

Area	Before	After
Form Experience	Single 50+ field form	4-step wizard, card headers, grouped fields
Progress Feedback	No indication of progress	Stepper, navbar chip, footer label, autosave
Error Handling	Generic top-of-page errors	Inline errors, red borders, toast notifications
Document Guidance	Plain text list, no upload UI	Card grid, green upload state, live count
Appointment Booking	Date picker + separate slot page	Side-by-side calendar + slots, live summary
Authentication	Username/password form	OTP-only, 30s countdown, inline error
Save & Sync	No autosave	45s + on step advance, pulsing dot, timestamp
Post-Submit	Basic confirmation	Celebration, ID copy, 3 export options, timeline

7. Component Architecture

Component	CSS Class(es)	Description
Navbar	.navbar	Sticky, 64px, navy, box-shadow
Screen Panel	.screen.active	display:flex + fadeSlideIn animation
Hero	.hero::before/::after	CSS grid 1fr 1fr, radial gradient glows
Auth Box	.auth-box, .tab-row	440px card, tab toggle, OTP row
Sidebar	.sidebar-link	240px, navy, hover/active states
Dash Cards	.dash-card::after	Coloured left accent via ::after pseudo-element
Stepper	.step-item	Flex row, ::before connector, 3 states
Autosave Bar	.autosave-dot	Flex between, CSS @keyframes pulse
Form Card	.form-card-header	White card, grey header stripe + icon
Upload Card	.upload-item.uploaded	Dashed → solid green on upload
Calendar	.cal-day	7-col grid, 5 button states
Time Slots	.time-slot.full	3-col grid, strikethrough / blue fill
Toast	.toast.show	Fixed bottom-right, cubic-bezier spring

8. Responsive Design & Accessibility

Mobile Breakpoint (max-width: 768px)

- Hero grid collapses from 2-column to 1-column
- All form rows collapse to single column
- Dashboard sidebar hidden — navigation moves to navbar
- Calendar + slots stack vertically

- Stepper wraps, horizontal connector line removed
- Auth box padding reduced for small screens

Accessibility Features

- All interactive elements use / — keyboard navigable
- Focus rings: 0 0 0 3px rgba on all inputs for keyboard visibility
- WCAG AA colour contrast: navy on white exceeds 7:1 ratio
- association on all controls — screen-reader compatible
- Semantic HTML: , , , ,
- Error messages use plain language, not only colour change

9. Design Decisions & Rationale

OTP-Only Authentication

Passwords are a barrier for infrequent users. OTP via mobile aligns with India's Aadhaar-linked mobile infrastructure and requires zero memorisation.

Dark Navy Colour Scheme

Government portals need authority. Navy communicates seriousness while sky-blue accents keep it approachable — not sterile or intimidating.

4-Step Form Instead of 1 Long Form

Multi-step forms reduce perceived complexity by 40-60%. Each step has a clear theme, reducing cognitive load and improving completion rates.

Autosave Every 45 Seconds

Passport forms take 20-30 minutes. Without autosave, any interruption loses all progress. 45s is safe without performance overhead.

Upload Cards Instead of File Inputs

Plain file inputs give no context. Visual cards show name, format, size limit, and status in a single glance.

Side-by-Side Calendar + Slots

Traditional booking requires 2+ page loads. Side-by-side eliminates transitions and lets users see slot availability before committing to a date.

Syne + DM Sans Fonts

Syne's geometric bold gives headings authority. DM Sans is warm, readable at small sizes, and designed for UI contexts.

No External Frameworks

Zero React/Bootstrap — portable, no build step, easy backend integration. Total under 100KB.

10. Evaluation Criteria Mapping

Evaluation Criteria	Weight	How This Design Addresses It
UX Thinking & User Understanding	25%	Personas, OTP for non-tech users, tooltips, plain-language copy, step-by-step guidanc
Problem Solving & Flow Design	25%	4-step wizard, autosave, upload cards, side-by-side booking calendar, confirmation tim
Clarity & Simplicity	15%	One task per screen, progressive disclosure, minimal noise, clear CTAs, inline hints
Visual Design (UI Quality)	10%	Syne+DM Sans, consistent palette, shadow system, spring animations, hover states
Product Thinking (Save/Sync/Export)	15%	Autosave every 45s with timestamp, PDF download, email receipt, share ID, dashboar
Originality & Creativity	10%	Custom calendar, upload card grid, animated stepper, toast animation — no template

Summary

PassportSeva demonstrates a complete, end-to-end redesign of India's passport application experience — addressing every deliverable in the assignment: user onboarding, core product screens, save/sync, cloud export, and UX improvements. The design is original, functional, and built with real code — not wireframes. Every decision has a rationale rooted in reducing user anxiety, increasing completion rates, and building trust in a government

service context.

Submitted for evaluation • Anshumat Foundation • PassportSeva UX Assignment • 2025